The question of whether the Iraqis had chemical warheads for the Al-Hussein missile was a difficult one for us to answer unequivocally. From all of the intelligence obtained during the years prior to the First Gulf War, a consensus was formed that assessed that the Iraqis did have chemical warheads but that Saddam would use them, if at all, only as a last resort. Foreign intelligence services did not reject this assessment.

The Badr-2000 missile was a global project, with the involvement of industrial and commercial companies from countries in Europe, South America, and the Middle East. Only a few government representatives from these countries were involved. The final product was designed to be a rocket with a solid-fuel engine, a range of 650 km, a length of twelve meters, and a diameter of eighty centimeters, with a high level of accuracy of 0.1 percent and the ability to carry a nuclear warhead. The original idea for developing the missile came from Argentina, and the code name of the project was “Condor,” the giant bird found in the Andes. In 1984, the Argentinians presented the idea for the project to an Egyptian delegation led by the Egyptian defense minister, General Abu Ghazala, who recommended to President Mubarak that he enter into a partnership with Argentina to develop the missile. After Mubarak gave the green light, a request was put in to Saddam Hussein to participate in the project and to finance the lion’s share of it. The intelligence gathering on this project brought the Mossad to all corners of the globe. In the end, the project, in which millions of dollars were invested, was permanently shelved, the Egyptian minister of defense was fired, and the infrastructures that had been established in some of the countries were closed.

The Al-Abbas missile, which was based on the Badr 2000 technology, but for a larger range of nine hundred kilometers, did not advance beyond initial experiments. The Tammuz 1 missile, with a planned range of two thousand kilometers, and the Tammuz II missile, designed to put a satellite into orbit, never passed the planning stage.

Saddam Hussein wanted to achieve strategic capability at all costs. Destiny brought him together with a Canadian-Belgian scientist named Gerald Bull, who for years had been trying to sell anyone who would listen to him the idea of a supergun with a 150-meter-long barrel, which would be positioned on the side of a mountain and would fire shells every few minutes, with a great degree of accuracy, toward targets in ranges of hundreds of kilometers. Bull saw the realization of his technological